

Incident handler's journal - SDR

Date: 06/17/2026	Entry: 1
Description	A small U.S. health care clinic experienced a security incident on Tuesday at 9:00 a.m. which severely disrupted their business operations. Malicious actors encrypted critical files and software, demanding ransom in exchange for the encryption key to unlock these files.
Tool(s) used	SIEM (Security information and event management) EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response)
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who - An organized group of unethical hackers who are known to target organizations in healthcare and transportation industries. • What - Targeted phishing emails compromised the system's security, allowing the hackers access to internal systems and files. Many of these resources were encrypted, disrupting business operations for the organization. • When - The incident occurred at 9:00am on June 17, 2026. • Where - The attack took place at a small U.S. healthcare facility in Prosper, Texas. The internal network at this facility was compromised remotely by the phishing incident. • Why - The incident was initiated when multiple employees of the organization engaged with malicious phishing emails, prompting malware to spread through the network.
Additional notes	Cybersecurity training and testing should be administered regularly to all employees of the organization, especially due to the serious threat the attack posed to patients of the healthcare facility. A simple lapse in judgement such as clicking on a malicious link could impact the lives of many workers and patients.

Date: 06/19/2026	Entry: 2
Description	Malware was sent via email to an employee in the guise of a legitimate business finance spreadsheet. An IDS alerted the security team of a suspicious file download on the employee's computer. The malware file was hashed and investigated using virustotal.com , which confirmed the threat event.
Tool(s) used	IDS - (Intrusion detection system) VirusTotal - (Malware detection) CLI Hashing - (Malware Identification)
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who - An unethical hacker who deployed a malicious attachment via email. The attack targeted a financial services company in Maine. • What - An email with a suspicious attachment was sent to a company employee. The employee downloaded and opened the file. Multiple unauthorized executable files were created on the target computer. Our IDS generated a security alert, prompting an investigation of the incident. The malware was detected, analysed, and removed from the employee's device. Final scans were then conducted to ensure no other files or devices were compromised during the attack. • When - The malicious email was received at 1:11pm, on June 19, 2026. The IDS alerted security professionals of a suspicious download at 1:20pm the same day. The threat was contained, removed, and documented by 1:42pm. • Where - Over the internet, targeting a financial services company located in Maine, US. • Why - A phishing tactic used by the hacker successfully prompted an employee to download and open a malicious file.
Additional notes	I'm curious about the source of the attack, mainly the IP and email address the file was sent from.

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Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.
